College of Marin
Community Education & Services
Course Outline

1. COURSE TITLE	2. TO BE FILLED IN BY STAFF: TOTAL NUMBER OF CLASS MEETINGS: TOTAL NUMBER OF HOURS:	TO BE FILLED IN BY STAFF: COURSE NUMBER
Aspects of Mindfulness: Cultivating Presence, Focus, and Compassion		

Course Description

Designed for community members seeking greater mental clarity, emotional balance, and sustained focus, this 7-week course explores the foundations and lived practices of mindfulness. Students examine how digital distraction, attentional drift, and chronic stress patterns deplete vital energy and fracture concentration. Through guided experiential practices, cognitive neuroscience insights, and supportive group discussion, we cultivate the 'two wings of practice'—clear seeing and an open, caring heart. Participants learn practical techniques to anchor attention, recognize the body's natural stress reflexes without self-judgment, and distinguish raw sensory experiences from runaway mental narratives. Students gain accessible, lifelong tools for calm, single-tasking focus, and compassionate living.

3. INSTRUCTORS NAME	4. PHONE NUMBER
Andy McGuire	(415)637-0348

5. ADDRESS

326 Larkspur Plaza Drive

6. CITY	7. STATE	8. ZIP CODE
Larkspur	CA	94939

9. E-MAIL ADDRESS sparkyflashrebob@gmail.com

10. DEGREES/CREDENTIALS/OTHER RELATIVE QUALIFICATIONS **(PLEASE ATTACH A FULL RESUME)**

MMTCP Certfied Mindfulness Meditation Facilitator (2023) & Mindfulness Educator since 2009; Meditation Teacher at two Recovery Centers and community leader.

11. MAXIMUM ENROLLMENT	12. OTHER
20-25	None (Open to all adult community members)

13. STUDENT LEARNING OUTCOMES (see back of form) **Upon completion of this course, students will be able to:**	14. CRITICAL THINKING SKILLS (see back of form) **During this course, students will develop or use these critical thinking processes or activities:**
1. Demonstrate Attentional Stability: Apply focused attention and sensory anchoring techniques to sustain focus, minimize cognitive drift, and practice single-tasking in daily activities. 2. Distinguish Sensation from Story: Differentiate between raw sensory input (the First Arrow) and secondary mental narratives, worry, or self-judgment (the Second Arrow). 3. Recognize Somatic Conditionality: Identify bodily tension (such as a tight or knotted stomach) as a conditioned biological survival response rather than a personal failure, using mindful pauses to restore physiological equilibrium. 4. Apply Mindful Communication: Practice deep, compassionate listening and thoughtful speech to enhance connection, reduce conflict, and foster empathy in personal and professional relationships.	1. Analyze Attention Dynamics: Analyze personal habits of digital distraction and multitasking, evaluating the mental cost of cognitive switching versus single-tasking focus. 2. Differentiate Perception from Interpretation: Differentiate between neutral sensory data entering through the senses and subsequent catastrophic interpretations or narrative biases. 3. Deconstruct Biological Stress Responses: Deconstruct automatic fight-or-flight reactions using principles of evolutionary biology, comparing wild animal threat recovery with human cognitive rumination. 4. Formulate Grounded Action Plans: Formulate individualized mindfulness and compassion protocols to interrupt automatic reactivity and redirect mental energy into constructive, skillful living.

15. METHODS OF INSTRUCTION (see back of form)	16. EVALUATION (see back of form)
Interactive lecture, guided experiential mindfulness and attentional exercises, somatic awareness practices, facilitated group reflections, partner listening dyads, and weekly home observation experiments.	Weekly self-reflective practice logs, active engagement in group discussions and contemplative exercises, self-assessment of attentional habits, and completion of a personal mindfulness and focus action plan.

17. SPECIAL ROOM REQUIREMENTS AND/OR LOCATION	18. LENGTH OF COURSE
Quiet, comfortable classroom with movable chairs arranged in the standard manner; whiteboard; AV projector/screen/or large display for presentation slides. Kentfield Campus.	7 weeks, meeting once weekly for 2 hours per session (14 total instructional hours). Standard COM Community Education quarter format.

Community Education Director /Date	CURRICULUM COMMITTEE REVIEW	VP Academic Affairs/Date	Date of Board Approval/Date
	DATE		

INSTRUCTIONS:

Electronic submission of this form is preferred. Please email completed outline to proposal@marincommunityed.com

COURSE DESCRIPTION: Consider mentioning the specific audience the course addresses, the course goal or focus, major topics, and unique or non-traditional methods of instruction. Note that this description may be edited for publication. Descriptions are limited to 130 words.

NUMBER is entered by Community Education Office.

13. STUDENT LEARNING OUTCOMES: Please list at least four measurable outcomes which will result from taking this class.

14. CRITICAL THINKING SKILLS: Give at least four examples to complete the sentence using active verbs. Refer to Bloom's Taxonomy.

15. METHODS OF INSTRUCTION: Indicate if course is lecture and/or discussion, computer-assisted, field trip, studio, movement, etc.

16. EVALUATION: Describe methods to be used in determining whether students have met stated Student Learning Outcomes.

18. LENGTH OF COURSE: The standard quarter is 7 weeks, although class schedules may vary greatly. A typical class meets 2 hours per week for 7 weeks; however, classes may be offered on days, evenings, weekends and in various combinations, including up to 8 hours on a weekend day.

19. COURSE TOPICS: List the major topics in a representative sequence from the beginning of the course to the end.

20. TEXTBOOKS AND REQUIRED MATERIALS: Please complete the information requested below. All texts are recommended, not required. Texts less than five years old preferred.

21. COURSE MATERIALS: Please be prepared to submit to the Community Education Office an example of any and all materials to be distributed in class. To be reimbursed for materials distributed in class, you must submit receipts.

19. COURSE OUTLINE (see instructions)

WEEK OR HOUR	CLASSROOM CONTENT
Week 1 (Hours 1-2)	Foundations of Mindfulness & Attention: The Spotlight & The Floodlight " Demystifying mindfulness; sensory breath anchors; working with cognitive drift.
Week 2 (Hours 3-4)	Single-Tasking & Focus in the Digital Age: Working with Distraction " Cognitive switching costs; digital boundaries; mindful single-tasking laboratory.
Week 3 (Hours 5-6)	The Two Wings of Practice: Balancing Clear Seeing and an Open Heart " Clear Seeing (Head) and The Open Heart (Compassion/Warmth); avoiding self-criticism.
Week 4 (Hours 7-8)	Stress Physiology & Somatic Conditionality: Belly Tightness & Threat Response " Biological survival reflexes vs personal failure; animal vs human threat recovery.
Week 5 (Hours 9-10)	The Two Arrows: Discerning Primary Impact from Mental Fiction " Raw sensory data (First Arrow) vs runaway mental narrative & catastrophizing.
Week 6 (Hours 11-12)	Mindful Communication & Compassion: Deep Listening in Daily Life " Deep listening without defense; noticing somatic tension; empathy practice dyad.
Week 7 (Hours 13-14)	Rewiring the Stress Habit: A Sustainable Blueprint for Daily Living " Shifting chronic stress into calm vitality; micro-pauses; personal action plan.

20. TEXTBOOKS AND REQUIRED MATERIALS (see instructions)

AUTHOR	TITLE	ISBN #, PUBLISHER LOCATION, NAME	PUBLICATION DATE

All texts recommended, not required (per COM Community Education guidelines):
1. Amishi P. Jha, Ph.D. - Peak Mind: Find Your Focus, Own Your Attention (HarperOne, 2021)
2. Tara Brach, Ph.D. - Trusting the Gold: Uncovering Natural Goodness and Healing the Heart (Sounds True, 2021)
3. Mark Williams & Danny Penman - Mindfulness: An Eight-Week Plan for Finding Peace (Hachette, 2021)

21. COURSE MATERIALS: ESTIMATED COST OF SUPPLIES

	EST. COST PER STUDENT	COMMENTS
MATERIALS FEE	$0.00	Digital handouts and syllabus provided via PDF
RENTAL	$0.00	Standard classroom space provided by College of Marin
FOOD FEE	$0.00	Students bring their own notebook and pen
ART SUPPLIES	$0.00	Not applicable
OTHER	$0.00	Not applicable